

Identifying Audiences and Purposes

- *Identify the uses of your communication and the routes it will travel*
- *Impact of co-operative/controversial/ethical ideas*
- *Impact of distortion /incompleteness /inaccuracy /bias*

Constructing Arguments

- Keywords: 5-7
- Forming a potential thesis/topic sentence or the main point of view: 25-30 words
- A thesis according to the Cambridge Dictionary is "A long piece of writing on a particular subject, especially one that is done for a higher college or university degree."
- Organizing ideas in an outline

Thesis statements: from a statement to an essay

Example of a thesis statement:

- An analysis of the college admission process reveals *one challenge* faced by counselors: accepting students with high test scores or students with strong extracurricular backgrounds.

The essay that follows should have discussion on two issues:

- Explain the analysis of the college admission process
- Explain the challenge faced by admissions counselors

(From: https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/general_writing/the_writing_process/thesis_statement_tips.html)

Example of thesis statement

High school graduates should be required to take a year off to pursue community service projects before entering college in order to increase their maturity and global awareness.

The essay that follows should:

- Present an *argument* and *give evidence* to support the claim that students should pursue community projects before entering college

(From:
https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/general_writing/the_writing_process/thesis_statement_tips.html)

Outline

To create an outline:

1. Place your thesis statement at the beginning.
2. List the major points that support your thesis. Label them in Roman numerals (I, II, III, etc.).
3. List supporting ideas or arguments for each major point. Label them in capital letters (A, B, C, and so on).
4. If applicable, continue to sub-divide each supporting idea until your outline is fully developed. Label them 1, 2, 3, and so on, and then a, b, c, and so on.

(From: <https://libguides.clmira.edu/research/outline>)

Stages of Argument Formation

- Main Point (begin with a good topic sentence/a clear introduction to your main idea)

1. First main line of argument

- A. First sub-argument for 1
 - i) First proof for 1A
 - ii) Second proof for 1A
 - iii) Third proof for 1A

B. Second sub-argument for 1

- i) First proof for 1B
- ii) Second proof for 1B
- iii) Third proof for 1B

Points to remember

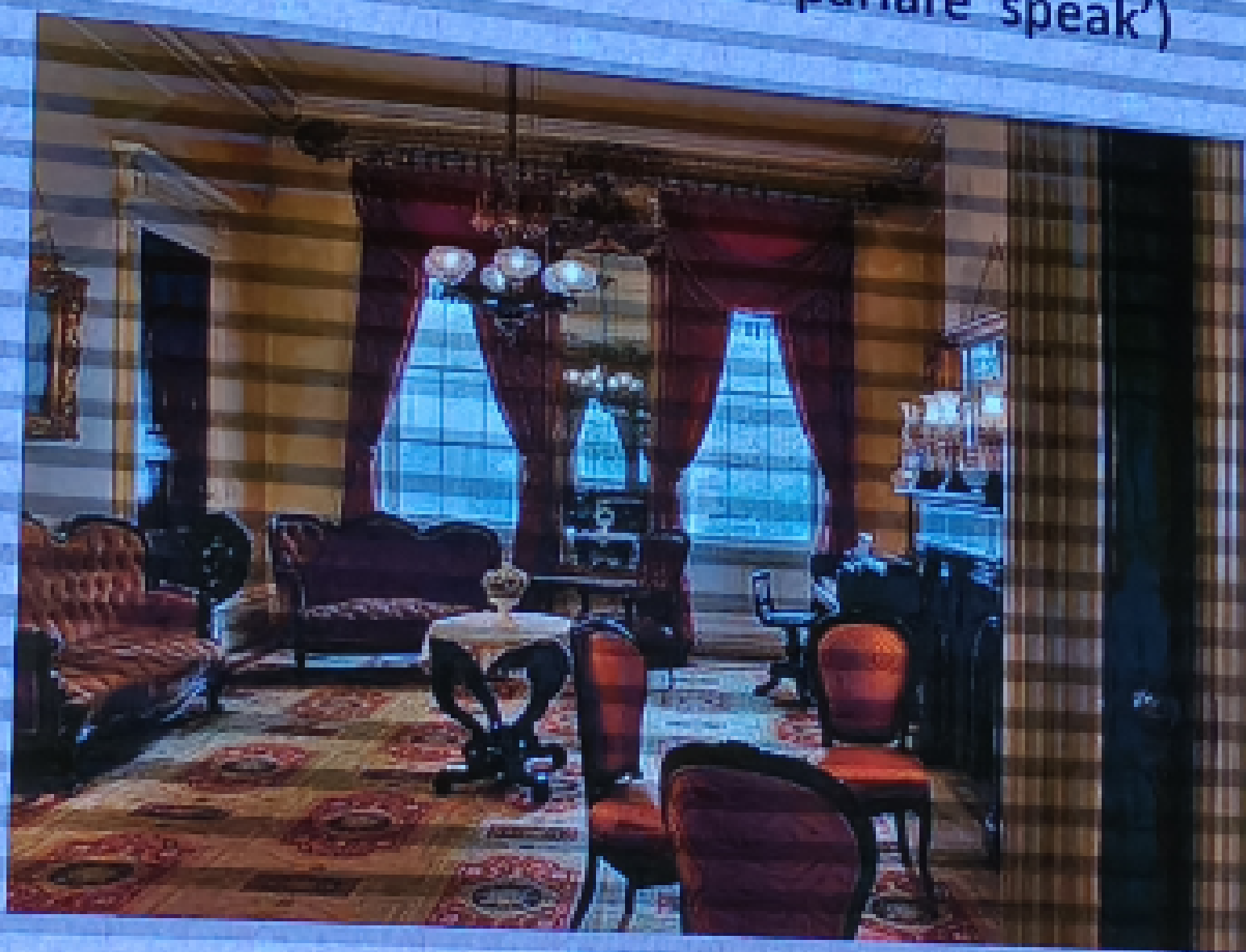
- As you write formally, your arguments need to be sensitive to global requirements
- If you wish to disagree with someone's point of view in formal communication, use facts and evidence
- Avoid personal attacks, remarks
- If you must use humor, do so only to diffuse difficult situations
- Do not use humor to mock or put down people in formal writing

*Scholarly Communication:
Building Knowledge
Systems*

The Burkean Parlor

(Parlor is a place for receiving guests)

Word root: from Anglo-Norman French parlur 'place for speaking', from Latin parlare 'speak')



Kenneth Burke in *The Philosophy of Literary Form* (1941)

"Imagine that you enter a parlor. You come late. When you arrive, others have long preceded you, and they are engaged in a heated discussion, a discussion too heated for them to pause and tell you exactly what it is about.

In fact, the discussion had already begun long before any of them got there, so that no one present is qualified to retrace for you all the steps that had gone before.

You listen for a while, until you decide that you have caught the tenor of the argument; then you put in your oar. Someone answers; you answer him; another comes to your defense; another aligns himself against you, to either the embarrassment or gratification of your opponent, depending upon the quality of your ally's assistance. However, the discussion is interminable.

The hour grows late, you must depart. And you do depart, with the discussion still vigorously in progress."

The Burkean Parlor of Scholarly Communication

- The importance of scholarly communication over time/generations/ages
- Accurately recording data is key to creating systems of knowledge
- This accuracy comes from how data is presented (plotted/argued/archived)
- Remember, we are all filling gaps in existing scholarship as we contribute new ideas/concepts/data sets

Communication and Knowledge Systems

- Systems of knowledge do not exist in vacuum; they develop over time
- As new systems of knowledge develop, they converse with older ones; like in the Burkean Parlor
- Through this continuum newer knowledge is born
- Communication/scholarly recording is key to synthesizing new ideas from existing older ones

The Planet Earth: From Aristotle to Newton

- Aristotle (384–322 BC): Greek philosopher; believed in uniqueness of the Earth which ***if not the center*** was ***at*** the center of the universe; he even spoke of the laws of motion (*On the Heavens* and many other works)
- Claudius Ptolemy (100 – 170 AD): Roman mathematician and astronomer; Geocentric theory
- Nicolaus Copernicus (1473 – 1543): Polish astronomer and mathematician; Heliocentric theory, round orbits (Huge quarrels with the Church; his followers such as Bruno burnt by the church for heresy)
- Galileo di Vincenzo Bonaiuti de' Galilei (1564 – 1642): Italian Astronomer; further advancements in physics and astronomy
- Johannes Kepler (1571 – 1630): German astronomer and mathematician; from gravity to telescope to elliptical orbits, and advances in astrophysics
- A century later, Sir Isaac Newton in England will further build on these